

HC Services — People Code

Section 2: Sick Leave Policy

Section 2.0: Document Control

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Version: 3.0

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Status: current

Owner: People & Culture Division

Version	Effective from	Superseded on	What changed
3.0	1 April 2026	—	Pay tranches rebalanced to 15 full / 45 half / 30 unpaid. Total entitlement unchanged at 90 days.
2.8	1 January 2025	31 March 2026	Tranches 15 full / 30 half / 45 unpaid. Retained in full at \$2.9.

Section 2.1: Policy Scope

This policy applies to all employees of HC Services from their first day of service, **including those serving probation**, in accordance with UAE Federal Decree-Law No. 33 of 2021. Entitlement during probation is subject to the payment restriction at §2.2.2.

Section 2.2: Sick Leave Entitlement

2.2.1 Entitlement and Pay Tranches

Employees are entitled to a maximum of **90 days** of sick leave per leave year. Pay depends on how many days of the 90 have already been taken in that year:

Days of the 90 used	Pay level	Percentage	Counts toward the 90
Days 1–15	Full pay (basic + fixed allowances)	100%	Yes
Days 16–60	Half pay	50%	Yes
Days 61–90	Unpaid	0%	Yes

The 90-day entitlement is counted across a **rolling 12-month period**, defined at HC-PC-007 §7.5, not per calendar year.

Worked example. An employee who has taken 50 sick days in the rolling 12-month period is paid in full for days 1–15, at half pay for days 16–50 (35 days), and would move to unpaid from day 61 onward.

2.2.2 Sick Leave During Probation

An employee serving probation accrues the full 90-day entitlement but is paid at **half pay from day one**, rather than the full-pay tranche at §2.2.1. Sick absence exceeding **30 calendar days** during probation extends the probationary period by the excess — see HC-PC-003 §3.6.1.

Section 2.3: Notification & Documentation Requirements

2.3.1 Notification

An employee unable to attend work must notify their line manager before **09:00** on the first day of absence, and on each subsequent day unless a medical certificate covering the period has been submitted.

2.3.2 Medical Certification

Self-certification is permitted for absences of **1 or 2 consecutive days**. From the **third consecutive day**, an official medical certificate issued by a DHA, DOH, or MOH licensed practitioner is mandatory and must be uploaded to Omni within **48 hours** of the third day.

Absence of three or more consecutive days without a certificate is treated as unauthorised absence under HC-PC-001 §1.8.

2.3.3 Certificates Issued Outside the UAE

A certificate issued outside the UAE must be attested by the relevant UAE consular authority, or accompanied by a report from a UAE-licensed practitioner, before the absence is recorded as certified sick leave.

Section 2.4: Return to Work

An employee returning from three or more consecutive days of sick leave must complete a return-to-work discussion with their line manager on the first day back, recorded on **Form HR-S-01** (see HC-PC-007 §7.9). The discussion is supportive, not disciplinary.

Section 2.5: Long-Term Illness

2.5.1 Definition

Absence exceeding **20 consecutive working days** is treated as long-term illness and is managed jointly by the line manager and People & Culture.

2.5.2 Capability Review

Where the 90-day entitlement in a rolling 12-month period is exhausted, the Company may commence a capability review under HC-PC-008 §8.2. A capability review is not a disciplinary process.

Section 2.6: Absence Management

2.6.1 Trigger Points

A review is triggered where an employee records **10 or more days** of sick absence, or **4 or more separate spells**, within a rolling 12-month period (HC-PC-007 §7.5).

2.6.2 Bradford Factor

The Company uses the Bradford Factor to weight frequent short absences more heavily than a single long one:

B = S² × D, where **S** is the number of separate spells and **D** is the total days absent in the rolling 12-month period.

Bradford score	Band	Action
0–49	No concern	None
50–124	Informal	Informal review with line manager
125–399	Formal	Formal counselling, recorded on file
400 and above	Referral	Referral under HC-PC-006 §6.3

Worked example. Four separate spells totalling nine days gives $B = 4^2 \times 9 = 144$, which falls in the Formal band and requires recorded counselling — even though nine days is below the 10-day trigger at §2.6.1.

Section 2.7: Abuse of Sick Leave

Falsifying a medical certificate, or claiming sick leave for a purpose other than genuine incapacity, is **gross misconduct** and is dealt with under HC-PC-006 §6.4.

Section 2.9: Appendix A — Superseded Provisions (Version 2.8)

SUPERSEDED — DO NOT APPLY TO ABSENCE ON OR AFTER 1 APRIL 2026. The provision below was in force from 1 January 2025 to 31 March 2026 under Version 2.8. The provision currently in force is §2.2.1. This appendix is retained because absence occurring before 1 April 2026 is paid under it.

A.1 Entitlement and Pay Tranches (Version 2.8, in force 1 January 2025 – 31 March 2026)

Employees are entitled to a maximum of 90 days of sick leave per year, paid as follows:

Days of the 90 used	Pay level	Percentage
Days 1–15	Full pay	100%
Days 16–45	Half pay	50%
Days 46–90	Unpaid	0%

Where a single period of absence straddles 1 April 2026, each day is paid under the rule in force on that day.

For queries about this policy, contact People & Culture at people@hcservices.ae or raise a query via the HCS Concierge.